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DESIGN MILESTONES

MILESTONE 1

Ritual Experience Discovery

01 KEYWORDS

Ritual
Daily routines
Mindful preparation

02 TRANSFORMED

Hot beverage preparation → ritual experience

03 AI ROLE

Clarifier

04 SELECTED PROMPT

Act as a behavior observer.
Analyze how ritual-oriented users experience hot beverage preparation in their daily routines. Identify their actions, emotional states, and sensory experiences during the preparation process.

05 AI RESPONSE SUMMARY

AI explained that preparing hot beverages often functions as a calming ritual rather than only a functional task. Sensory cues such as steam, aroma, warmth, and visual changes create a moment of pause in daily routines.

06 ACCEPTED

Ritual-based interaction

07 REJECTED

Purely functional beverage machines

08 REFLECTION

Preparing a drink can create a meaningful pause in daily routines.

09 DESIGN DECISION

The product should emphasize experience rather than efficiency.

MILESTONE 2 *Psychological Transition Insight*

01 KEYWORDS

Transition
Pause
Mental reset

02 TRANSFORMED

Daily task → psychological transition moment

03 AI ROLE

Re-framer

04 SELECTED PROMPT

Act as a reframer.
Describe the emotional roles that hot beverage rituals play in daily routines and how they help users transition between activities.

05 AI RESPONSE SUMMARY

AI described preparation rituals as moments that help users shift mentally between activities. The process provides a small pause that supports emotional comfort and focus.

06 ACCEPTED

Calm interaction

07 REJECTED

Fast automation logic

08 REFLECTION

The ritual moment is as important as the drink itself.

09 DESIGN DECISION

The product must support slow and intentional interaction.

MILESTONE 3 *Sensory Brewing Opportunity*

01 KEYWORDS

Sensory perception
Steam
Aroma
Visual brewing

02 TRANSFORMED

Hidden process → visible sensory experience

03 AI ROLE

Critique

04 SELECTED PROMPT

Identify which sensory experiences during beverage preparation have the strongest impact on user perception and ritual engagement.

05 AI RESPONSE SUMMARY

AI highlighted sensory elements such as visible infusion, steam, aroma, and gradual color change as key contributors to ritual experience.

06 ACCEPTED

Visible brewing

07 REJECTED

Closed brewing systems

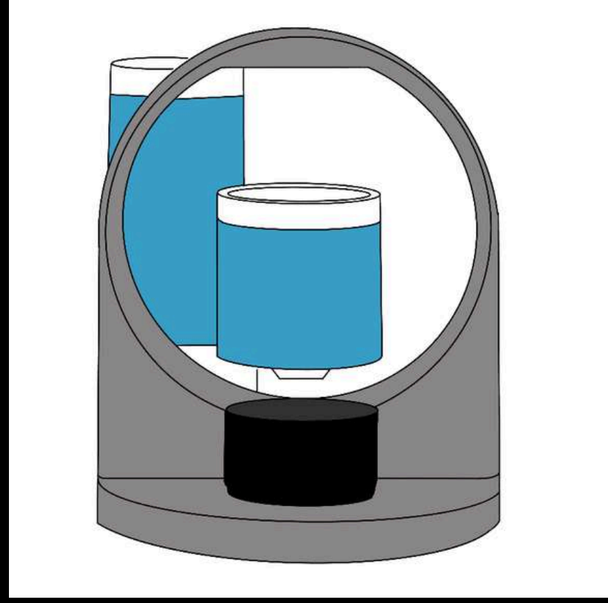
08 REFLECTION

Most appliances hide the brewing process.

09 DESIGN DECISION

The infusion process should remain visible to the user.

MILESTONE 4 *Halo Concept Direction*



01 KEYWORDS

Halo
Focus
Zen inspiration

02 TRANSFORMED

Form element → functional water channel

03 AI ROLE

Expander

04 SELECTED PROMPT

Explore product forms that visually emphasize the brewing process while maintaining a calm and minimal aesthetic.

05 AI RESPONSE SUMMARY

AI suggested framing the brewing process visually and guiding attention toward the center of the product. Circular structures were proposed as forms that represent flow and continuity.

06 ACCEPTED

Halo structure

07 REJECTED

Conventional vertical machine layout

08 REFLECTION

The halo frames the brewing chamber and creates a visual focus.

09 DESİGN DECISION

The halo becomes both a visual frame and a water channel.

MILESTONE 5 *Ritual Interaction Scenario*

01 KEYWORDS
Participation
User interaction
Intentional gesture

02 TRANSFORMED
Automatic brewing → participatory ritual

03 AI ROLE
Expander

04 SELECTED PROMPT
What types of user interactions can strengthen ritual engagement while keeping the experience simple and calm?

05 AI RESPONSE SUMMARY
AI proposed small participatory actions such as placing herbs, observing the infusion, and removing the chamber after brewing.

06 ACCEPTED
Manual herb placement

07 REJECTED
Fully automatic brewing

08 REFLECTION
User participation strengthens ritual meaning.

09 DESIGN DECISION
Users actively participate in the preparation process.

MILESTONE 6 *Product Architecture Development*

01 KEYWORDS
Water system
Pump
Heating

02 TRANSFORMED
Concept idea → functional system

03 AI ROLE
Critique

04 SELECTED PROMPT
Evaluate the internal working principle of my herbal infusion device and identify missing components in the system.

05 AI RESPONSE SUMMARY
AI identified essential system components such as a water tank, heating element, pump, and water flow path.

06 ACCEPTED
Thermoblock heater
Micro pump system

07 REJECTED
Gravity-only water flow

08 REFLECTION
Water cannot move upward without a pump.

09 DESIGN DECISION
The system includes reservoir → heater → pump → halo channel.

MILESTONE 7 *Brewing Chamber Structure*

01 KEYWORDS
Glass chamber
filtration system
infusion control

02 TRANSFORMED
Simple chamber → structured brewing system

03 AI ROLE
Clarifier

04 SELECTED PROMPT
Design the internal structure of the brewing chamber including the upper cap, water inlet tube, herb basket, micro filter, and drip outlet.

05 AI RESPONSE SUMMARY
AI described a layered brewing structure including a water inlet, herb basket with mesh filter, secondary micro filter, and drip outlet to ensure clean infusion.

06 ACCEPTED
Multi-stage filtration syster

07 REJECTED
Single filter system

08 REFLECTION
Filtration is necessary for clean herbal infusion.

09 DESIGN DECISION
The chamber uses layered filtration and controlled dripping.

MILESTONE 8 *Cleaning Ritual Integration*

01 KEYWORDS
Cleaning ritual
user interaction
product lifecycle

02 TRANSFORMED
Cleaning process → ritual closure

03 AI ROLE
Expander

04 SELECTED PROMPT
Design a cleaning ritual scenario where the user removes, empties, rinses, and replaces the brewing chamber after preparation.

05 AI RESPONSE SUMMARY
AI proposed a cleaning sequence including removing the chamber, disposing herbs, rinsing the filter, and placing the chamber back into the halo structure.

06 ACCEPTED
Removable brewing chamber

07 REJECTED
Permanent fixed brewing chamber

08 REFLECTION
Cleaning can become part of the ritual experience.

09 DESIGN DECISION
The brewing chamber is removable and easy to rinse.

FINAL CONCEPT

The final design transforms herbal tea preparation into a calm and mindful ritual experience. The project explores how herbal tea preparation can be transformed into a mindful ritual experience rather than a purely functional kitchen task.Instead of focusing on speed or automation, the design emphasizes calm interaction, visible brewing, and sensory engagement.

KEYWORDS

- Ritual
- Mindfulness
- Sensory experience
- Transition
- Herbal infusion
- Calm interaction
- Participatory experience
- Zen circle

OVERVIEW

Many kitchen appliances focus on efficiency and automation.
However, research showed that preparing hot beverages often functions as a daily ritual and psychological transition moment.
The design therefore aims to transform herbal infusion into a slow, sensory, and mindful experience.